



FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 17

KANSAS

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — the first cross-state dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Kansas's family courts and child-welfare system.

118

KANSAS FAMILIES ON RECORD · 207
CHILDREN IMPACTED · 24 MONTHS
MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING
TIME

REPORT GENERATED
APRIL 26, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED
27 OF 105

COMPILED BY
MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

KANSAS AT A GLANCE.

Across 118 Kansas families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED 207 118 of 118 families reported child counts	MEDIAN ATTORNEY FEES \$12,000 per reporting family	MEDIAN MONTHS LOST 24 of parenting time	WENT PRO SE 50.0% 38.1% after running out of money
SUBMISSIONS 118	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY 1.8	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN 118 of 118	COUNTIES REPRESENTED 27

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Kansas families — and families in every state — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · [STANDWITHMEG.COM](https://standwithmeg.com)

02 THE COST OF KANSAS FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	73	\$12,000	\$42,603	\$3,110,009
Lost Wages	63	\$10,000	\$40,133	\$2,528,351
Other Court Fees	41	\$200	\$3,751	\$153,781
Therapy / Evaluations	57	\$1,500	\$4,646	\$264,795
Reunification Services	46	\$100	\$2,052	\$94,406
GAL Fees	60	\$2,000	\$5,640	\$338,404
Asset Loss ¹	53	\$54,000	—	—
Estimated Median Family Impact	—	\$79,800	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median (\$54,000) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

Median months lost		24	2 yrs
Mean months lost		38	3.2 yrs
Total across all families		2,145	178.8 yrs

03 WHO IS REPORTING · KANSAS

Most families documenting in Kansas are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed		51	43%
Not provided		30	25%
Case closed: within last 2 years		19	16%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago		12	10%
I was a Child of Family Court or CPS		3	3%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Both Family Court and CPS		46	39%
Family Court Only		46	39%
Unknown		18	15%
CPS (Child Protective Services) Only		8	7%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years		23	19%
5 – 10 years		20	17%
3 – 5 years		18	15%
Over 10 years		13	11%
6 months – 1 year		10	8%

CUSTODY STATUS

No Contact / Total Loss of Access		39	33%
Visitation Only		25	21%
50/50 Joint		23	19%
Adopted Out (Rights Terminated)		9	8%
Full Custody		9	8%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Johnson		19	16%
Shawnee		9	8%
Miami		4	3%
Lyon		3	3%
Sedgwick		3	3%
Wyandotte		2	2%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)		27	23%
Other: (Short answer)		15	13%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)		14	12%
High Conflict Divorce		8	7%
Child Protective Services (CPS / DCF)		5	4%

05 PARENT VOICES — KANSAS

Quotes appear as submitted. Long submissions are trimmed with [...] to fit the page; the full unedited quote is available in the online version of this report.



The Kansas court system is so corrupt. It's not even funny and judge Mativi is my judge. She awarded custody to someone who had no witnesses when I had five witnesses saying he smoked marijuana with my kids in the room and abused me and the children.

— CIERRA

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

Lost custody due to not having representation at all,, and the judge not bothering to investigate the false claims. I never even got a chance to speak or give evidence.

— KANSAS PARENT · TRISH

MORE VOICES FROM KANSAS

It didn't just take my 5 kids—it took birthdays, holidays, and the everyday moments that make a family. We've been forced to live in a nightmare of silence, separation, and trauma that never should have happened. This system protected court insiders and unchecked power instead of [...]

— MEGHANN

They almost broke me, they took my kids, forced me to leave my husband alienated us individually. And then when I kept fighting they used threats and coercion to force me out of my kids lives. I fought against corruption, abuse of power and trafficking, and lost. I survived but [...]

— DESIREE

The system has stolen my children's primary caregiver from them literally overnight, for no reason, causing unnecessary trauma to all of us.

— TAYLOR

Systematically destroyed and traumatized my daughter. Set her up to go into an abusive relationship. My daughter wrote the judge a personal letter, called dcf, and reported her fathers abuse to the police twice. She was totally ignored and forced to remain with her psychopathic [...]

— SATAH

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



It's legalized extortion- judicial mafia- attorneys and judges are all in on it. Casa, CPS and local pd - no one really cares- inept and unprofessional

— KELLY

Corrupt judges, attorneys and other court appointed professionals abused their position to extort money from my family by issuing orders and directives for the sole purpose of causing harm to my children. These officers of the Court are intentionally committing crimes for the [...]

— MIKE

The system is failing my daughter by dismissing abuse claims because the opposing attorney knows our GAL and it seems our GAL is unable to remain unbiased. My case is one sided and leaning always toward dad. What's best for the children is no longer what the system is going off [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My exhusband had criminal charges for taking the life of our unborn child through DV and would not allow my daughter to get me medical help. He was charged for 1 misdemeanor (domestic battery) and 1 felony charge (intimidation of a minor) in 2022. GAL Heather Landon was on the [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system recognizes the abuser then gives your children to them. The system is used to continue to control and abuse Domestic Violence Survivors, and to retraumatize them repeatedly.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My Grandmother (whom i was living with) died of a heartattack the day they came and took my daughter, while she was lying there dying she kept saying "dont let the paramedics see you here taking care of your daughter" (they gave me one hour to move out of my house that day. My [...]

— TIFFANY

All I do is cry. Not because I am hurting. Because of the unimaginable pain my children are in with out me. They barely had a childhood between their father killing his self in front of us (me and the twins at 3 years old) and being ripped away from mommy at 7 and a half years.

— TINA

The system has destroyed our lives

— MATTHEW

Failed to protect me and my children who are victims of a crime, Level 7 and level 10 felony, Expects money in return for justice.

— COREY

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



Caused my children trauma and placed them with my abusive ex husband.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ripped up apart. Made us broke & homeless. Every time I try they knock me down. They never say a good thing about me or anything I do or have done. The judge said she wasn't comfortable letting me keep my kids. There was lies made up about me & i love my kids very much and im [...]

— JASMYN

Gaslighted and emotionally abused my family.

— KIMBERLEE

Stole my kids and never helped me get the resources or support they are promising families to reintegrate.

— LISA

Cause depression, loss of time and mental abuse on siblings and family members

— ANNETTA

Deprived my son and I of our God given rights as a father and son

— JOHN

After dealing with Lewanna Bell-Lloyd, and CPS, it proved to me there's no "justice" in the justice system.

— PAUL

Never, in the history of humanity, have children had their medical, educational, adjudicative, due process and administrative needs met by a series of portals and videoconferences set up entirely in response to a pandemic that has long passed. Children are being sold back to [...]

— SHAWN

Ripped us apart and stole my children's chances at a happy healthy childhood and adulthood.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



System has broken us financially and my children's mental health, depleted resilience, created distrust

— JOANNA

I fought for my children with everything I had in me. I followed every rule, met every demand, jumped through every hoop they placed in front of me, but all they did was move the finish line. The system was never built on fairness, it is built on power. And when you stand [...]

— ALI

Taken away time together we can never get back. Make my children and I feel we had no control or voice

— SHAE

Turned my children against me we don't talk they have no respect for me I don't get to see grandbaby's nothing

— JENNIFER

Devastated..given me a drive to shut it down. The kids are a close friend of mine.

— KEVIN

This system has cut me out of my daughter's life and have manipulated her and turned her against me and have handed her over to her pedophile father who never wanted anything to do with her and only wants her now for her disability check and he has already committed tax fraud by [...]

— APRIL

Missing out out on my kids whole youth years. Ill never get the time back.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I was the primary caretaker for my children prior to divorce, post divorce we had 50/50 custody and time. She stalked me, controlled schedules, and manipulated the situation because she is the "mother" and she wanted control so took me back to court over things that could have [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Traumatized my son to the point he begs for me & says he doesn't like Daddy.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



They have taken my child and everything i owned. Im living witjout power and water

— DUSTIN

What was suppose to be a short weekend visit turned into months of separation from my daughter,even though there were no finding of abuse or neglect. The time and memories lost between parent and child are something that no system or courts can ever truly give back. I am sharing [...]

— LINDSEY

The system allowed my abuser to escape all consequences to the point of his criminal charges being dismissed and helped Dad turning me into the abuser. The system has stripped me of any belief that leaving my abuser was the right choice. I wish I would have stayed, at least I [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The court system has taken Away my son's mother my other kids brother Kevin o Grady needs to be exposed he claims he does things for the kids safety no he breaks families

— EMILY

Have my child to their abuser.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has ripped apart my family and caused a divide. It caused half of my family to want nothing to do with me due to their lies.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

CAUSED ME SERIOUS HEALTH AND STRESS ISSUES

— MONICA

It taken away most of my past 20 years and will always.

— ANNIE

Destroyed a family because of someone's feelings with no evidence to substantiate claims

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

73 Kansas parents submitted ranked quotes. 42 appear in this report; the remainder are available at standwithmeg.com/ks.

06 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a national, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Kansas report comes from Kansas respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Kansas — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 118 Kansas families reporting here are not the universe of Kansas families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. We flag outliers and report medians when means are distorted (see page 3, note 1). Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – April 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

When a respondent's financial entry differs from the population by more than three standard deviations, the mean is suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 5 independent families name the same actor.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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